The Drain-Day Recovery Card

A drain day is different from a low-battery day. On a low-battery day, the tank is low and the menu (sheet 3) helps. On a drain day, something specific emptied the tank — a hard conversation, a surprising bill, a bad shift, news that fell heavy. Drain days need *recovery*, not productivity, and recovery has its own small steps.

Print this and fold or clip it wherever you'll see it. The idea is that on the day itself you do as little *thinking* as possible: the card already knows what to do. You just follow the next kindest line on it.

1. Fill in your personal recovery items while things are okay — the card works best pre-loaded with things that genuinely help *you*.
2. On a drain day, start at the top: pause first, then the floor of the low-battery menu, then a card item.
3. Say the card's one sentence out loud if you can. It's short on purpose: *"Today is a recovery day. Small counts."*

Recovery days aren't lost days. They're the maintenance schedule for the machine that does everything else you do.

Not medical advice, just logistics for the aftermath of a hard one. If drain days stack up day after day, that's information worth giving a professional.

Drain-Day Recovery Card

For the day after something heavy. Small counts. All of it optional. Fill the blanks on a good day.

Pause first — the first hour

- ☐ Sit or lie somewhere soft with nothing to decide for ten minutes
- ☐ Tell someone the plain version: "Rough day, recovering tonight."
- ☐ Cancel or move the one thing that can move (I'm allowed) _____

My floor — the minimum that keeps the day held

- ☐ Food: _____
- ☐ Meds / routine item: _____
- ☐ Comfort object or place: _____

My recovery menu — things that have actually helped *me*

BODY ONES	MIND ONES

Body examples: shower, walk, stretching, water, the specific nap. Mind examples: an easy show, a familiar book, a game, tidying one drawer, one small chat.

Off-limits today — my drain-day no list

Heavy planning is a no. Big decisions are a no. Rereading the hard conversation is a no. The news is a no. Answering "what's the plan for life?" is a no.

My additions: _____

Tomorrow starts tonight — the tiniest hand-offs

- ☐ One glass of water by the bed
- ☐ One note to tomorrow-me: _____
- ☐ Tomorrow gets one small starter, already written down here: _____

Say the sentence: "Today is a recovery day. Small counts." It's still true if it takes more than a day.
